ANNUAL REPORT

2025-26



sama

Where yesterday's devices power tomorrow's innovators

How do we make sure people are not left behind in the technology race?

When I started Sama, this was the question driving me.

Every day brings new developments in AI and technology. And yet, there are women and young people across India who don't have access to a basic laptop - the starting point for almost everything that follows.

Sama began as our answer to that gap.

This year was about access.

Getting devices into hands that had never held one. Building the infrastructure to do it reliably. Learning often the hard way what it really takes to run this work at scale.

Next year is about something bigger. Not just access but what happens after the device arrives. We want the laptop to become a gateway: to learning, to livelihoods, to a future that wasn't visible before.

We are building the ecosystem to make that possible. We have a long way to go. But we also have everything we need, a team that believes in this cause , partners who show up, and donors who make it real.

Thank you for being part of this.



Manisha Sinha

Founder, Sama Digital Foundation

THE PROBLEM

65 MILLION TONNES

OF E-WASTE



The world generated over 65 million metric tonnes of e-waste in 2025 and that number is estimated to rise to **82 million** by **2030**

1.41M MT
e-waste generated in India

70%
of it from computer devices

Lead, Mercury, Cadmium
toxic metals in e-waste



THE PROBLEM

ONLY 1 IN 3 WOMEN

USE THE INTERNET

India is home to **691 million women**
Yet only one in three has ever used the internet

74%
women in rural India cannot use laptops for basic tasks

7%
households in India own a laptop or computer

50%
women are unable to perform online banking transcations



THE SOLUTION

E-waste is rising. Digital access is unequal. Sama is the bridge between them

Sama is a nonprofit that bridges the digital divide by giving end-of-life corporate devices a second life as tools for education, livelihoods, and transformation

We collect unused laptops from companies, refurbish them with care, and place them in the hands of those who need them most

Not charity. A system of access

REFURBISHMENT
Repaired, Restored, and Made Functional

CORPORATES
Unused Devices from Companies

CIRCULAR ECONOMY OF EMPOWERMENT

BENEFICIARIES
Women and Youth Across India

IMPACT
Access to Learning, Jobs, and Growth

Our Mission

To empower 1 million women and youth by 2030 through technology while keeping thousands of tonnes of e-waste out of landfills

HOW IT WORKS

From discarded devices to real-world opportunity

DISCARDED DEVICES



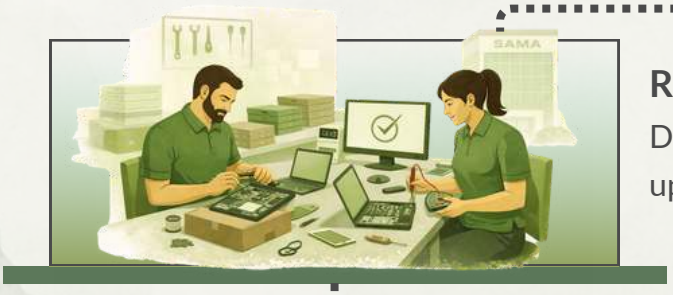
COLLECTION

Devices are collected from corporate partners, ensuring secure and responsible sourcing



ASSESSMENT

Each device is carefully assessed for usability, ensuring only viable systems move forward



REFURBISHMENT

Devices are repaired, restored, and upgraded to become fully functional tools



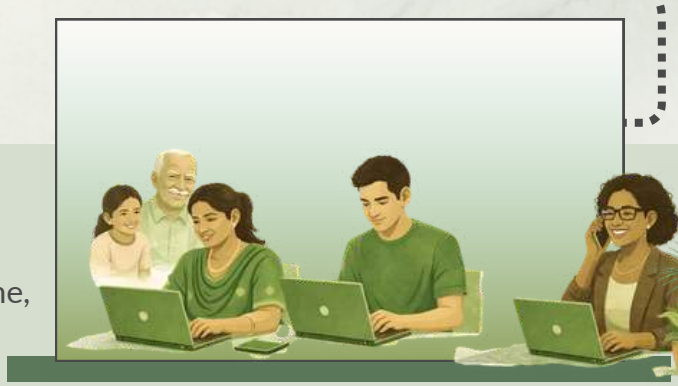
DATA SANITISATION

All data is securely wiped, maintaining complete privacy and trust



DEPLOYMENT

Laptops are distributed to women and youth through trusted partner networks



IMPACT

The device becomes a gateway to learning, income, and independence

IMPACT AT SCALE

Measured in Lives, Not Just Numbers

At Sama, every refurbished device is more than just technology, it's an environmental act that creates opportunity for people while protecting the planet

15,000
Devices Refurbished

2,10,000+
Women and Girls Reached





3,20,502
Cumulative Impact



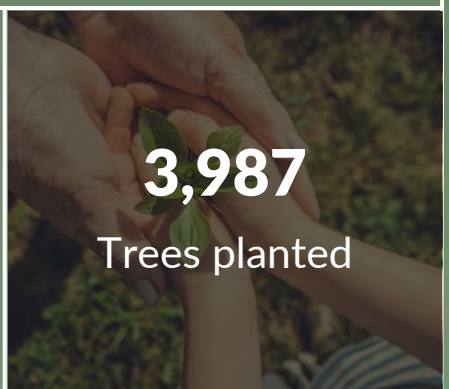
1,627
Schools Impacted

~3,975 MT CO_2
Emissions Saved

Every refurbished laptop saves approximately 265 kg of CO_2 equivalent to planting 12 mature trees. Since most of a device's carbon footprint is created before first use, extending its life by 3–4 years prevents nearly 94% of emissions associated with manufacturing a new one

1,028
Jobs Supported

51
NGO Partners across India



3,987
Trees planted

WOMEN OF SAMA

These are not statistics. These are people whose lives changed because a laptop arrived

PRIVITRA

Lost her job at HDFC Bank after sudden hearing loss, leaving her without a clear path forward.
Through Youth for Jobs and access to a Sama laptop, she retrained for a computer-based role.

Today, she manages a team of 10+ people at a finance company earning independently again and supporting her family.



ANJALI

While supporting her low-income family and continuing her studies in Delhi, Anjali faced constant financial pressure. A Sama laptop helped her build digital skills and complete her training. Now she works as a Sales Executive at Zudio, earning ₹18,419 per month.



TARA JI

For years, Tara Ji managed waste collection work manually, with limited access to digital tools. A Sama laptop enabled her to transition to maintaining digital records with confidence. Today, she works more efficiently with greater independence and dignity.



WOMEN OF SAMA

SEEMA KUNJAM

Seema joined the Bal Mitra Fellowship after completing her Class 12, having never used a laptop before she felt hesitant at first. With Sama's support, she learned everything from typing and email to attending online meetings and writing reports.Today, she uses her laptop independently and contributes to her community with greater confidence.



KHUSHI

Coming from a background with limited exposure to technology, Khushi had never used a personal computer before. Through Sama, she received her first laptop and began exploring digital learning. Today, she is building confidence and preparing for new opportunities.



DANTEWADA & BASTAR GIRLS

In remote, conflict-affected regions like Dantewada and Bastar, access to education is often disrupted. Sama laptops helped girls return to school and continue learning. Today, they are building digital skills and expanding their future opportunities.



OUR PARTNERS

Partnerships that power scale creating access, opportunity, and lasting impact

Corporate Partners

EATON
Capgemini
Tiger Analytics
SG Analytics
A Strive Company
DXC TECHNOLOGY
Apexon IGNITE
Microsoft
amazon
MACQUARIE
accenture

Implementation Partners

AIF AMERICAN INDIA FOUNDATION
ATMADEEPAM SOCIETY
बचपन बनाओ
bala vikasa
Code to Enhance Learning
ConveGenius.AI
Deaf EnAbled FOUNDATION
Deshpande Skilling
esther
LIGHTHOUSE COMMUNITIES
FIA
lfe LEADERSHIP FOR EQUITY
LEARNING LINKS FOUNDATION
WASTE WARRIORS
REDUCE RE-USE RECYCLE
medha
nav gurukul
peepul
Pifinity Education Foundation
PI JAM FOUNDATION
PROJECT SHIKSHA
The Quest Center
SANJHI SIKHIYA
SEWA BHARAT
SIGNSETU
SSISM
TRRAIN TRUST
unicef
Visthar
Youth 4 Jobs
Asha for Education Chennai

BEHIND THE WORK - THE TEAM

90% of Sama's Operations Team are Women

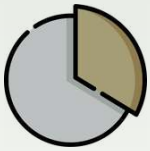
Most were beneficiaries before they were colleagues. That's not coincidence it's what the model is designed to do



> **Sama runs on people. We build pathways for change**

CHALLENGES & LEARNINGS

We believe transparency is part of accountability.
Here is what this year actually looked like



25,000 → 15,000 Laptops

We aimed to process 25,000 laptops. We reached approximately 15,000

The gap was real. Building a strong, diligent operations system is harder and more time consuming than we anticipated. We are investing in better processes, clearer onboarding, and stronger team culture in 2026



The Partner Reality

We did not bring in as many corporate partners as we aspired to and recurring commitment proved hard to secure. Reaching new companies was one thing. Converting conversations into long-term partnerships was another. Many interactions led to one-time donations

What Sama needs is a partner who builds device retirement into their annual cycle, not just a single CSR action. This is a strategic priority for 2026



3× Cost Increase

Component costs tripled. SSDs and RAM increased nearly 3x over the year. Refurbishment budgets were not built for this

We are recalibrating our cost models and exploring bulk procurement partnerships

CHALLENGES & LEARNINGS

Rising Hardware Complexity

Hardware complexity increased. We encountered more motherboard-level faults than expected: power IC failures, dead systems requiring component-level repair beyond standard refurbishment

Our team is actively upskilling to handle this in-house

51 Partners. Limited Visibility.

M&E data gaps remain. Tracking real-time impact across 51 partners is an intensively difficult task

We implemented stronger follow-up protocols this year and will continue improving this in 2026

Systems matter as much as heart. We have always had the heart. We are now building the systems



THE ROAD AHEAD 2026

50,000

Laptops

Doubling our impact by reaching more learners faster and more efficiently

With stronger systems in place, 2026 is about scaling what works with intention, consistency, and depth

1 Strengthening Career Pathways



Beyond access, we aim to enable outcomes. Building clearer pathways from device access to skills, employment, and income generation

2 Operational Efficiency



Improving turnaround time, reducing costs, and building more predictable systems across sourcing, refurbishment, and deployment

3 Stronger Team & Culture



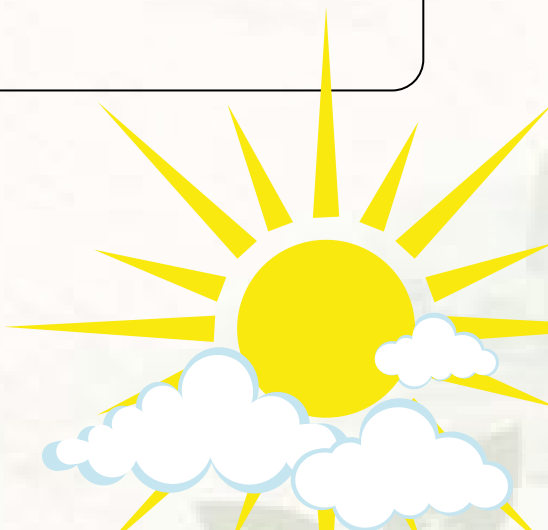
Investing in people through better training, clearer roles, and a culture of ownership and accountability

4 Deepening Partnerships



Moving from one-time support to long-term collaborations, integrating device donation into regular corporate cycles

From building the foundation to scaling the model, *2026 is about doing more, better*



HOW YOU CAN SUPPORT

Be a part of this journey of enabling access, opportunity, and impact



1 Donate Devices

Turn idle laptops into tools for learning and livelihoods. Your organisation's retired devices can directly enable access for those who need it most

2 Build Corporate Partnerships

Go beyond one-time giving. Integrate device donation into your organisation's annual cycle and create sustained impact

3 Make Introductions

Open doors for scale. Connect us with organisations that can contribute devices or collaborate in meaningful ways.One warm introduction can become 500 laptops

4 Support the Ecosystem

Strengthen the system behind the impact. Support operations, refurbishment, and capacity-building as we scale sustainably



Every device we restore, every learner we reach, is made possible by people who choose to act

IN THEIR WORDS. IN THEIR WORLDS.

Moments from the journey where access turns into opportunity.



A First Laptop. A New Beginning.



Access that Changes Pace



Learning, Uninterrupted



Small Tools. Big Shifts.



More than a Device



Not Charity. Capability.

Sama Digital Foundation
2025–26

www.thesama.in Sama Digital Foundation